

STEVEN P. RYAN

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EDUCATION

University of Toronto

PhD in Economics

2018 - 2025

MA in Economics

2014 - 2015

Dalhousie University

MA in Economics

2010 - 2012

Carleton University

Bachelor of Public Affairs and Policy Management

2004 - 2009

RESEARCH

Working Papers

“Riding Out the Downturn: The Re-Employment Effects of an Unemployment Insurance Extension”

“A Helping Hand Goes a Long Way: Long-Term Effects of Counselling and Support to Workfare Program Participants” (joint with Gustavo J. Bobonis, Aneta Bonikowska, Philip Oreopoulos, and W. Craig Riddell)

“Child Benefits, Welfare, and Work”

Work in Progress

“The Performance of Performance Payments”

WORK EXPERIENCE

Ministry of Children, Community and Social Services

June 2017 - present

Senior Research Analyst

Toronto, ON

- Lead the design and implementation of randomized evaluations of pilot initiatives, including employment services for youth with disabilities, performance incentives for employment services providers, and a redesigned child support payment system.
- Develop and evaluate a statistical profiling model to automate referrals of social assistance applicants to employment services, integrating predictive analytics into program operations.
- Proposed and secured leadership approval in principle for a new outcome-based incentive model for service partners, replacing aggregate targets with performance-linked payments. Built consensus across analytics, program, and performance teams, addressed risks of strategic responses, and gained support to incorporate testing to generate evidence on optimal incentive levels.
- Conduct research using linked administrative data to estimate the impacts of provincial social assistance and employment programs on labour market outcomes.
- Facilitate researcher access to Ontario government administrative data on social assistance, employment services, and justice interactions to support evidence-informed policymaking.

Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL)*Policy Manager, Senior Policy Associate*

May 2015 - May 2017

Cambridge, MA

- Led partnerships with governments and non-profits across North America to assess the feasibility of randomized evaluations and design studies that generated actionable evidence for policy and practice.
- Mobilized academic researchers, public officials, and philanthropic funders to co-develop and launch impact evaluations addressing priority policy questions in employment, housing, and social services.
- Secured major philanthropic funding, including writing proposals and negotiating agreements that supported multi-year initiatives advancing evidence-informed policymaking.
- Designed and delivered trainings for senior officials and practitioners on using rigorous evidence and quantitative methods to improve decision-making.
- Authored publications and policy briefs translating research findings into accessible insights for policymakers, funders, and practitioners.
- Supervised and mentored junior staff, ensuring high-quality project delivery and fostering professional development across the team.

Health Canada*Policy Analyst*

February 2008 - August 2010

Ottawa, ON

- Prepared briefing notes, background materials, and talking points for meetings of federal, provincial, and territorial Deputy Ministers and Ministers of Health.
- Engaged in direct consultations with provincial and territorial government representatives on proposed health legislation and regulations.
- Worked collaboratively with other federal departments and agencies to align on emerging issues in the health sector, ensuring a consistent position.
- Researched positions of provincial and territorial governments on health issues to enable senior officials to respond to a wide range of topics.

TEACHING

Teaching Assistance - University of Toronto

ECO 100	Introduction to Economics
ECO 101	Principles of Microeconomics
ECO 102	Principles of Macroeconomics
ECO 306	American Economic History
ECO 315	Economics of Poverty
ECO 342	Twentieth Century Economic History: Institutions, Growth and Inequality
ECO 343	Labour Economics and Public Policy
ECO 401	Topics in Economic Policy
ECO 456	Public Policy Analysis
ECO 2408	Econometrics

COMPUTER SKILLS

Stata, R, Python, SAS, SQL, L^AT_EX**CITIZENSHIP**

American, Canadian